

BIGORANGE.MARKETING

Custom Home Builder Authority System

Final Pilot Proposal and Leadership Decision Packet

Interview-integrated content, keyword ownership, release plan, measurement, and next-phase roadmap

62	19	3	90
KEYWORD DECISIONS	OWNED ASSETS	PILOT DRAFTS	DAY RELEASE PLAN

DECISION PURPOSE Approve the exact authority-hub direction and review gates, then release one coherent builder-marketing system without fragmenting the existing commercial URL.

Proposal field	Confirmed position
Prepared for	Margee, Paula, Janice, and BigOrange leadership
Prepared by	Dillon Mohr, DM Marketing Specialist
Prepared	August 28, 2026
Pilot truth	35 hours at \$30/hour; approved total \$1,050
Decision date	September 3, 2026 leadership review
Status	Complete proposal package; publication remains approval gated

CONFIDENTIAL WORKING PROPOSAL | NO PUBLIC CLAIM OR PUBLICATION IS IMPLIED

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Executive decision

What leadership is approving and why it is ready now.

RECOMMENDATION Approve one authority hub at the existing /marketing-agency-for-builders/ URL, select a single visual direction, and release the pillar plus two supporting articles only after Janice closes factual and public-use permissions.

The system being approved

This pilot converts a broad builder-services page into a focused authority system for custom home builders while preserving the existing URL that already owns relevant commercial intent. The system is deliberately smaller than the full keyword universe: one hub, distinct supporting reader jobs, explicit internal links, governed evidence, and a review loop that learns from real queries and qualified actions.

The final package now includes the audit and research foundation, the 62-query decision ledger, a 19-asset ownership map, the revised pillar, two complete supporting articles, a visible FAQ and schema candidate, a 90-day release sequence, a 12-month roadmap, AI-search implementation guidance, and publication QA gates.

Why this is stronger after Janice's interview

- The audience is framed around real builder growth moments: uneven pipeline, referrals slowing, an aging website, stretched internal marketing capacity, succession, or a shift into a new service mix.
- Trust is treated as a proof sequence, not a slogan: excellent project photography, current digital presence, customer evidence, a clear process, direct answers, and a low-pressure next step.
- The content answers questions builders commonly leave unresolved, including pricing guidance, site work, permits, architecture, land, design-build responsibility, and what marketing support actually includes.
- The plan separates demand generation from sales follow-up. A raised hand is not automatically a qualified opportunity, and the lead definition remains a leadership decision instead of a fabricated metric.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY Janice sent the recordings for analysis, but the formal public-use permission readback was not captured. Only the anonymized Homearama example has explicit paraphrase permission. Every other interview-derived public claim remains a factual-review draft.

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Commercial truth and scope

A final proposal should make the approved commitment unmistakable and keep future work separate.

35	\$30	\$1,050
APPROVED HOURS	HOURLY RATE	APPROVED TOTAL

Included in the current pilot

- Audit of the current builder page and surrounding authority opportunity.
- Competitor and keyword research, content architecture, and AI-search strategy.
- One interview-integrated authority hub and two complete supporting articles.
- Implementation specification, metadata, internal-link logic, FAQ/schema candidate, and release QA gates.
- 90-day roadmap, governed editorial workflow, final leadership packet, and bonus 12-month roadmap.

Mapped, but not produced in this pilot

- Ongoing social post production.
- A broader downloadable asset beyond the mapped checklist and worksheet concepts.
- Video production or a webinar.
- The eleven next-phase articles, guides, subpillars, galleries, and tools in the authority roadmap.

PRICING BOUNDARY This packet does not invent a next-phase price. Cadence, production mix, ownership, revision allowance, payment timing, and acceptance mechanics must be scoped after leadership chooses the continuation model.

State	Commercial position
Confirmed	35 hours, \$30/hour, \$1,050 total, pilot deliverables, Phase 2 exclusions
Decision required	Invoice recipient and timing, payment timing, revision allowance, acceptance, ownership, confidentiality, portfolio use
Not claimed	Payment receipt, publication, traffic growth, ranking gains, lead volume, revenue, AI citations, or rich results

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The content authority system

One commercial owner, distinct supporting jobs, and a complete path from discovery to qualified conversation.

The hub-and-spoke model

1. **Attract.** Capture builder-specific informational and commercial questions through distinct pages that match a real reader job.
2. **Prove.** Use original expertise, project photography, process evidence, client-approved examples, and direct answers that reduce uncertainty.
3. **Connect.** Link every supporting asset to the canonical builder hub and to the next logical decision page without creating duplicate intent.
4. **Convert.** Offer a low-pressure next step and preserve enough context for sales to evaluate fit, response time, and follow-up status.
5. **Learn.** Review actual queries, engagement, assisted actions, and lead-quality feedback before expanding the cluster.

Three production-ready pilot assets

ID	Draft	Approx. length	Primary next step
HUB-01	Custom Home Builder Marketing That Builds Trust Before the First Call	2,564 words	Schedule a non-sales call
ART-01	Why Your Home Builder Website Is Not Generating Qualified Leads	1,292 words	Request a builder website clarity review
ART-02	5 Articles Every Custom Home Builder Blog Needs	1,060 words	Schedule a builder content planning call

Canonical ownership rules

- HUB-01 owns agency, company, firm, services, solutions, system, and broad home-builder-marketing commercial variations.
- ART-01 owns the diagnostic intent around a website not generating leads and website optimization; WEB-01 owns design, development, and service-comparison intent.
- ART-02 owns home builder blog and editorial-ideas intent; CNT-01 owns the broader content-marketing operating system.
- VIS-01 owns broad SEO and digital-visibility intent; LOCAL-01 owns local SEO; SEOCHK-01 owns the narrow on-page phrase/checklist intent.
- STR-01 owns marketing plans, strategies, and tips; AUD-01 owns market segments and new-builder audience framing.
- No asset is published until its reader job, primary query, canonical, and reciprocal internal links are documented.

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Pilot content: what is ready

The copy is complete as a review draft; claims and publication remain gated.

HUB-01 | EXISTING AUTHORITY HUB

Custom Home Builder Marketing That Builds Trust Before the First Call

Primary query owner: custom home builder marketing. Primary CTA: Schedule a non-sales call.

- Leads with excellent work and project photography instead of generic agency claims.
- Frames the marketing problem around trust, clarity, proof, discoverability, demand, and follow-up.
- Addresses referrals, an aging website, uneven pipeline, DIY marketing, and the 'work should speak for itself' objection.
- Preserves /marketing-agency-for-builders/ as the single commercial owner.

ART-01 | SUPPORTING DIAGNOSTIC ARTICLE

Why Your Home Builder Website Is Not Generating Qualified Leads

Primary query owner: home builder website not generating leads. Primary CTA: Request a builder website clarity review.

- Separates low traffic, poor-fit traffic, weak proof, unclear scope, friction, and incomplete follow-up.
- Gives a corrective sequence instead of treating a redesign as the automatic answer.
- Supports the hub without competing for agency or service-page intent.
- Creates a natural bridge to the website-design subpillar and SEO checklist.

ART-02 | SUPPORTING EDITORIAL ARTICLE

5 Articles Every Custom Home Builder Blog Needs

Primary query owner: home builder blog. Primary CTA: Schedule a builder content planning call.

- Turns repeated buyer questions into five durable article types tied to actual decisions.
- Explains how one SME interview can support articles, FAQs, email, sales follow-up, social, and video planning.
- Keeps the broader content-marketing system for CNT-01 to prevent duplication.
- Ends with a planning conversation rather than a ranking promise.

COMPANION COPY PACKAGE The complete editable pillar, two complete articles, visible FAQ set, and matching FAQ schema candidate are included beside this proposal for line-by-line review and WordPress implementation.

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Keyword and intent strategy

The 62-row ledger is a decision system, not a promise to publish 62 pages.

62	58	4	1
QUERIES REVIEWED	ASSIGNED	REJECTED	CANONICAL HUB

The keyword plan combines dated Semrush demand and difficulty evidence, dated Moz rank and URL evidence, live-site verification, funnel intent, reader job, and ownership. Blank evidence is treated as unknown, not as zero. The workbook preserves all raw fields and separates build decisions from source limitations.

Priority clusters

Cluster	Owner	Representative demand
Core authority	HUB-01	custom home builder marketing; home builder marketing; agency/company/firm variations
Visibility	VIS-01 / LOCAL-01	SEO for home builders; SEO for custom home builders; local SEO for home builders
Website	ART-01 / WEB-01 / GAL-01	website not generating leads; website design; examples; best websites
Strategy and audience	STR-01 / AUD-01	marketing plan; strategies; target market segments; new home builder marketing
Lead operations	LEAD-01 / NUR-01 / AUTO-01	lead generation; CRM; email; nurture; automation; sales alignment
Content	ART-02 / CNT-01 / SOC-01	home builder blog; content marketing; social media marketing

Rejected and validate-first demand

- Reject generic agency terms such as 'digital marketing agency' and 'SEO agency' for this focused pilot.
- Reject homeowner-intent queries such as 'custom home builders near me' and 'how much does a custom home cost.'
- Validate ambiguous phrases such as 'custom home builder website,' website classification criteria, and home builder market research before production.
- Protect the existing hub's commercial relevance rather than splitting near-synonyms into thin competing pages.

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The 19-asset portfolio

Every keyword has an owner, every owner has a reader job, and every build window is explicit.

SCOPE READ Three assets are complete current-pilot drafts. Eleven assets are mapped as next-phase production candidates. Social production is explicitly Phase 2, while the remaining assets stay in backlog or validate-first state.

ID	Asset	Window	State
HUB-01	Custom Home Builder Marketing That Builds Trust Before the First Call	Current pilot	Complete interview-integrated draft
ART-01	Why Your Home Builder Website Is Not Generating Qualified Leads	Current pilot	Complete interview-integrated draft
ART-02	5 Articles Every Custom Home Builder Blog Needs	Current pilot	Complete interview-integrated draft
STR-01	A Practical Home Builder Marketing Plan	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
VIS-01	SEO, Local Search, and AI Visibility for Home Builders	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
WEB-01	Home Builder Website Design, Proof, and Conversion	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
AUD-01	Custom Home Builder Target Market Segments	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
LEAD-01	Home Builder Lead Generation and Follow-Up	Days 61-90 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
LOCAL-01	Local SEO for Home Builders: Markets, Reviews, and Proof	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
NUR-01	Home Builder Email Marketing, CRM, and Lead Nurture	Days 61-90 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
AUTO-01	Marketing Automation for Home Builders Without Losing the Human Touch	Days 61-90 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
SOC-01	Social Media Marketing for Home Builders	Phase 2	Brief ready; production explicitly excluded from current pilot
CNT-01	Home Builder Content Marketing That Answers Real Buyer Questions	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
GAL-01	Best Home Builder Websites: Examples and Evaluation Criteria	Days 61-90 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
TPL-01	Home Builder Website Templates and Platforms: What to Evaluate	Backlog / after authority foundation	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
SEOCK-01	Recommended Phrases and Page Elements for Home Builder Website SEO	Days 31-60 / next phase	Brief ready; production not included in current pilot
MKTRE S-01	Home Builder Market Research: A Practical Framework	Quarter 2 or 3 after proof assets	Validate intent and methodology before production
PPC-01	PPC for Home Builders	Backlog	Deferred until conversion tracking and proof are validated
CONSU LT-01	Home Builder Marketing Consulting	Backlog	Do not build until leadership confirms a distinct offer and non-cannibalizing intent

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90-day release and expansion plan

The first 30 days are a governed release sequence. Expansion begins only after the foundation is verified.

Timing	Asset / gate	Scope	Current state
Gate 0	Approval and source closure	Current pilot	Blocked on reviewers
Week 1	HUB-01, ART-01, ART-02	Current pilot	Drafts ready for review
Week 2	Technical release package	Current pilot	Specification ready
Week 3	WordPress staging	Current pilot	Requires staging target
Week 4	Foundation release	Current pilot	Approval gated
Week 5	Release verification	Current pilot	After publication
Week 6	STR-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 7	VIS-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 8	WEB-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 9	LOCAL-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 10	AUD-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 11	LEAD-01	Next phase	Not included in current pilot
Week 12	Quarterly authority review	Next phase	No outcome forecast

Release logic

1. **Gate 0.** Close Janice factual and permission review, leadership direction, imagery, owners, and the staging target.
2. **Weeks 1-2.** Close copy, metadata, links, technical requirements, analytics, CRM, schema, accessibility, performance, and rollback preparation.
3. **Weeks 3-5.** Assemble staging, run final QA, publish only the exact approved revision, then verify the live result separately.
4. **Weeks 6-12.** Build the first next-phase subpillars only under a separately approved production scope and refreshed evidence.

EXPECTATION SETTING Ninety days is enough to launch a healthy foundation and learn from early demand signals. Six months is the more realistic window for momentum. This is a sequencing principle, not a traffic, lead, or revenue forecast.

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12-month authority roadmap

A sustainable rhythm: one substantial asset, one meaningful refresh, one proof or tool, and one measurement question.

Month	Focus	Primary asset	Measurement question
1	Approve and release the foundation	HUB-01, ART-01, ART-02	Indexation, tracking, lead-definition baseline
2	Strategy and audience	STR-01	Query mix and consultation path
3	Visibility	VIS-01 and LOCAL-01	Search Console, local/entity consistency
4	Website conversion	WEB-01	CTA path and qualified actions
5	Audience fit	AUD-01	Market/project fit feedback
6	Lead handoff	LEAD-01 and NUR-01	Response time, acceptance, nurture status
7	Content engine	CNT-01	Editorial time, content use, assisted actions
8	Automation	AUTO-01	Follow-up completion and exceptions
9	Visual proof	GAL-01	Project-page engagement and next steps
10	Short-form distribution	SOC-01 if separately approved	Qualified assisted visits, not vanity reach
11	Platform decisions	TPL-01 and SEOCHK-01	Decision support and sales use
12	Research and consolidation	MKTRES-01 only with a defensible method	Qualified demand and assisted pipeline after validation

The roadmap is a planning model, not a production commitment. Each month requires an owner, approved scope, current source review, claim permissions, and release QA. Underperforming or overlapping assets should be refreshed, consolidated, or pruned rather than multiplied.

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SEO, AI-search, and technical implementation

Useful original content, clear ownership, and crawlable structure are the strategy; there is no separate AI-search shortcut.

Implementation principles

1. **Preserve one representative URL.** Keep the existing builder URL as the canonical commercial hub. Supporting assets own distinct reader jobs and link back to it.
2. **Make expertise attributable.** Use named reviewers, first-hand observations, original visuals, dated sources, and explicit claim permissions.
3. **Answer the whole decision.** Provide direct answers, scope clarity, process, proof, objections, and a logical next step instead of producing shallow query variants.
4. **Keep machine-readable markup honest.** Use schema only when it matches visible content and the page type. Do not duplicate organization, breadcrumb, or FAQ markup.
5. **Measure field performance.** Use Search Console and real-user Core Web Vitals data for actual evaluation. Lab tools guide diagnosis but are not proof of field experience.
6. **Control crawlers intentionally.** Review search and training crawler policy as a business decision. Do not change robots.txt reflexively or imply that access guarantees inclusion.

Page-level release specification

- Confirm title, meta description, one H1, canonical, breadcrumbs, indexability, and sitemap behavior.
- Install reciprocal internal links and document the reader job and primary query owner.
- Match visible FAQ copy and FAQ schema exactly; do not promise a Google FAQ rich result.
- Verify desktop/mobile layout, keyboard and focus behavior, reduced motion, overflow, accessibility, forms, console output, analytics, and performance.
- Record a rollback snapshot and owner before publication, then verify the live rendered state after release.

NO GUARANTEE No ranking, traffic, lead, revenue, AI citation, answer-engine inclusion, featured snippet, or rich-result outcome is promised in this proposal.

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Measurement and lead handoff

The scorecard separates visibility, engagement, qualified actions, sales handling, and business outcomes.

Layer	What to observe	Source	Cadence
Technical foundation	Indexation, canonical selected by Google, sitemap status, crawl errors, Core Web Vitals	Search Console, field data, release log	After release and monthly
Demand visibility	Query mix, impressions, clicks, landing pages, nonbrand visibility	Search Console and dated rank tools	Monthly; no guaranteed target
Content usefulness	Engaged sessions, scroll depth where configured, CTA progression, internal-link paths	Analytics and behavior instrumentation	Monthly
Qualified actions	Consultation requests, calls, form completions, downloads, assisted actions	Analytics and CRM reconciliation	Weekly / monthly
Sales handling	Response time, acceptance, owner, status, nurture completion, disqualification reason	CRM and sales-owner review	Weekly
Business outcome	Qualified opportunities and assisted pipeline only after definitions and attribution are validated	CRM and financial evidence	Quarterly

Qualified-lead definition to complete

- Audience and market fit: builder type, geography, service area, and project type.
- Business fit: need, urgency, decision authority, current capacity, and willingness to invest.
- Engagement fit: raised-hand action, requested service, context supplied, and response status.
- Sales outcome: accepted, nurture, disqualified with reason, or no response after documented follow-up.

OPEN DEFINITION Janice described an MQL as a raised hand, but the full scoring model was not completed in the recorded interview. Leadership and sales must approve the definition before any conversion claim is used.

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Editorial governance and permissions

Interview insight becomes public content only through a documented review path.

Claim lifecycle

1. **Capture.** Record the source, speaker, date, timestamp, working claim, and intended asset.
2. **Classify.** Mark the claim as experience, opinion, process, terminology, estimate, or client example.
3. **Verify.** Check every number, name, result, award, ranking, timeframe, and platform behavior against an original source.
4. **Permission.** Assign an explicit public-use code and required anonymization. Silence is not permission.
5. **Edit.** Convert approved evidence into precise reader-facing language without adding magnitude or certainty.
6. **Release.** Publish only the exact reviewed revision, then verify the live page separately.

Interview material currently held

- Audience boundaries across custom builders, production builders, developers, master-planned communities, and remodelers.
- Any revenue or business-maturity threshold.
- Trigger moments, trust factors, photography guidance, website questions, referral limits, objections, and terminology.
- The full qualified-lead definition and measurement language.

EXPLICIT PERMISSION The anonymized Homearama example may be paraphrased. The visitor estimate, named client, timeframe, performance implication, and any other result still require independent verification before use.

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September 3 leadership decisions

The system is ready for a bounded approval conversation, not an open-ended rewrite.

#	Decision	Required resolution
1	Visual direction	Choose Cinematic Authority, Orange Press, or an explicitly bounded hybrid.
2	Canonical owner	Confirm /marketing-agency-for-builders/ remains the one authority hub.
3	Approvers	Name owners for copy, claims, visuals, technical changes, publication, and rollback.
4	Staging	Confirm the WordPress staging target, production target, access path, and rollback owner.
5	Imagery	Approve hero, project photography, article featured images, releases, and alt-text owner.
6	Measurement	Approve the scorecard and complete the qualified-lead definition.
7	Continuation	Choose next-phase cadence, deliverable mix, ownership, and production scope.
8	Commercial terms	Confirm invoice/payment timing, revisions, acceptance, ownership, confidentiality, and portfolio use.

Janice review checklist

- Confirm audience boundaries and remove or confirm the tentative maturity threshold.
- Approve the edited positioning, trust, photography, website, referral, pricing-guidance, and objection language.
- Approve five to eight visible FAQ answers and matching schema candidate.
- Complete the qualified-lead definition.
- Approve or reject the anonymized Homearama paraphrase and assign public-use codes to all other interview language.

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Acceptance and release gates

Completion of the proposal is not the same as approval, publication, or verified live performance.

Pilot package acceptance

- Leadership confirms the packet reflects the approved 35-hour pilot and no additional production has been implied.
- Janice confirms factual accuracy and permission states for interview-derived language.
- Leadership selects the visual direction and exact WordPress revision path.
- Commercial mechanics are documented: invoice, payment, revisions, acceptance, ownership, confidentiality, and portfolio use.
- The content workbook and companion drafts are accepted as the operating source package for implementation.

Publication gate

- Approved copy and imagery are installed in staging.
- Metadata, canonical, breadcrumbs, internal links, sitemap behavior, and schema are verified without duplication.
- Visible FAQ copy and FAQ schema match exactly.
- Desktop/mobile, keyboard/focus, reduced motion, overflow, accessibility, console, links, forms, analytics, and performance pass final QA.
- Rollback snapshot and owner are recorded.
- Publication is approved for the exact revision, then the live page is reverified independently.

CURRENT STATUS Proposal, workbook, content drafts, and operating plan are complete. Janice review, leadership decisions, WordPress staging, publication approval, and live verification remain open.

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Evidence and source notes

Current verification, dated exports, professional opinion, and approval-gated interview evidence are kept separate.

Source	Freshness	Use	Boundary
Janice call recordings	Aug. 28, 2026	Audience, objections, trust, website, timing, example	Most public permission unresolved
Approved paid-pilot proposal	Reconciled Aug. 3, 2026	Scope, 35 hours, \$30/hour, \$1,050	Commercial mechanics open
Semrush keyword map	Aug. 4, 2026	Demand, intent, difficulty, CPC	Dated; not a forecast
Moz rankings export	Through Aug. 14, 2026	Protect existing URL ownership	Not a current live rank check
Current builder page	Verified Aug. 28, 2026	HTTP 200, self-canonical, live copy, JSON-LD	Current state; not replacement approval
Google Search documentation	Verified Aug. 28, 2026	AI features, people-first content, canonical, structured data, FAQ	Official guidance; no outcome promise
Web Vitals guidance	Verified Aug. 28, 2026	Field-performance measurement	Use real-user data for pass/fail

Official implementation references

- Google Search: Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search
- Google Search: Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content
- Google Search: Guidance about AI-generated content
- Google Search: Canonicalization and duplicate URL guidance
- Google Search: Structured data policies and FAQ rich-result changes
- Google Search: SEO Starter Guide
- Web.dev: Web Vitals
- OpenAI and Perplexity crawler-control guidance

FINAL POSITION Approve the governed foundation first. Publish one coherent hub and two distinct supporting articles. Learn from actual queries and qualified actions. Expand only when the evidence, ownership, and production scope justify the next asset.